

Odisha: India's Emerging Global Sports Destination



Once known primarily for hockey, Odisha is evolving into a dynamic multi-sport hub, where world-class facilities, international competitions, and grassroots development converge to create a sustainable sporting ecosystem. The year 2025 has been one of remarkable milestones for Odisha's sporting calendar. The state hosted India's first-ever World Athletics Continental Tour Bronze 2025 at the Kalinga Stadium, drawing over 200 athletes from 19 countries. Adding to that momentum, the 28th ITTF-ATTU Asian Table Tennis Team Championships 2025 brought continental-level action indoors, with world champions and top paddlers from Asia competing in Bhubaneswar. The successful execution of back-to-back international meets reflected the state's growing expertise in hosting complex, multi-nation events.

Alongside global events, Odisha played host to several prestigious national tournaments this year. The 40th National Junior Athletics Championships 2025 saw the country's brightest young track and field talents competing at the Kalinga Stadium a vital platform for India's next generation of athletes. The All India Senior National Ranking Badminton Tournament drew top Indian shuttlers. The courts of

Bhubaneswar buzzed with energy as national stars and rising players battled for ranking points and recognition. Meanwhile, the 78th Senior National Aquatic Championship 2025 transformed the state's world-class swimming facilities into a vibrant arena for competition with representation from all major swimming federations and aquatic disciplines. In Football, Kalinga Super Cup 2025 and ISL 2024-25 added consistency to the sporting calendar.

Looking ahead, Odisha's sports journey continues with renewed enthusiasm. The state will soon host the Odisha Masters 2025. (December 9-14, 2025), a marquee event on the BWF World Tour. Come 2026, Odisha will see the return of the Hockey India League and FIH Pro League which promises to reignite the passion of hockey fans across Bhubaneswar and Rourkela. Further, AFI has announced that India's first National Indoor Athletics Championships will be held at Kalinga Stadium in 2026, a quiet but significant addition to Odisha's growing sports story.

As the world turns its gaze toward the eastern coast of India, one truth stands out; Odisha isn't just hosting sport; it's building the future of Indian sport, one event at a time.